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TRACER Risk Assessment Report Case Study

Risk scenarios, treatment logic, and management implications

Prepared by Mallory Davis

System	TRACER - Training Records and Compliance Evidence Repository
Fictional organization	Arclight Mission Systems
Prepared by	Mallory Davis
Assessment purpose	Demonstrate how selected control weaknesses become risk scenarios with treatment recommendations.
Status	Fictional portfolio work sample. Not an official risk acceptance or authorization decision.

Risk posture: TRACER presents a moderate readiness risk. The most important exposure is not a single tool gap. It is the combination of privileged access exceptions, aged vulnerabilities, and incomplete monitoring consolidation.

1. Scope and system context [Back to TOC](#)

This report evaluates selected risks identified from the TRACER SSP and Security Controls Assessment case studies. It focuses on risk scenarios relevant to access, auditability, vulnerability remediation, and monitoring discipline.

2. Methodology Back to TOC

- Identify the weakness or control gap.
- Define the threat event that could exploit the gap.
- Estimate likelihood using available case-study evidence.
- Estimate business or operational impact.
- Assign a qualitative risk rating and recommend treatment.

Rating	Meaning
High	A gap could materially weaken system assurance or create a clear decision point for leadership.
Moderate	A gap is meaningful and should be tracked through corrective action, but does not by itself indicate immediate severe impact.
Low	The issue requires attention but has limited system-level consequence in this case study.

3. Risk register Back to TOC

ID	Risk Scenario	Condition	Threat Event	Likelihood	Impact	Risk	Treatment
R-01	Privileged access exception misuse	Break-glass access lacks a repeatable evidence package.	Unauthorized or unreviewed privileged activity could occur without timely detection.	Moderate	High	High	Mitigate
R-02	Audit review gaps reduce detection confidence	Weekly review cadence is not consistently evidenced.	Unusual account activity or export behavior may not be escalated promptly.	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	Mitigate
R-03	Aged high vulnerabilities remain unresolved	Two high items exceed the internal remediation target without consolidated escalation.	Known weakness remains available for exploitation longer than intended.	High	High	High	Mitigate
R-04	Tabletop action items do not reach closure	Exercise follow-up does not define completion evidence.	Response weaknesses may persist without leadership understanding readiness drift.	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	Mitigate
R-05	Monitoring view does not support one posture decision	Open findings, scan status, and incident readiness actions are separated.	Leadership may receive fragmented risk signals and delay decisions.	Moderate	Moderate	Moderate	Mitigate

4. Treatment logic Back to TOC

Risk	Recommended action	Reason
R-01	Formalize break-glass approval, MFA evidence, and periodic review.	This narrows privileged exception exposure and creates evidence reviewers can reperform.
R-02	Define required log review record fields and maintain weekly completion evidence.	This improves detection confidence and reduces uncertainty during assessment.
R-03	Escalate aged high findings through a single management tracker.	This prevents open items from being split across tools without a decision owner.
R-04	Track tabletop corrective actions to closure with proof.	Exercises only improve readiness when open actions are resolved.
R-05	Create a monthly system posture summary.	This supports one decision view across findings, scans, and remediation activity.

5. Management decisions supported Back to TOC

Decision Needed	Why it Matters	Recommended Stance
Should privileged access exception use continue under the current evidence model?	Current records do not fully support consistent approval, authentication, and review.	Continue only with remediation underway and defined closure evidence.
Should aged high vulnerabilities receive escalation outside the technical queue?	The remediation target has been exceeded and the issue lacks a single decision record.	Yes. Escalate through POA&M ownership and monthly posture review.
Should TRACER use one consolidated monitoring summary?	Separate records create blind spots across findings, vulnerabilities, and incident readiness.	Yes. Use one monthly summary until open risks decline.

6. Conclusion Back to TOC

The TRACER case study shows a moderate overall risk posture with one high-priority remediation theme: management cannot rely on distributed evidence alone when privileged access, vulnerability aging, and monitoring status require coordinated decisions. The recommended response is targeted mitigation through a POA&M that states ownership, dates, escalation, and closure proof.